THE MADE REAL BLUEPRINT / PHASE 1

I stay in the town I know, *and I get my evenings back.*

I work four days, and the fifth day is outdoors. I am outside every day, even when the weather is bad.

Sam · In 8 weeks

01 Picture
In the first week

02 Explore

03 Decide
In 8 weeks

WHAT I AM CHOOSING NOW

Here. The same flat. Go and change where I am.

One full month on four-fifths pay, with the rent and the bills paid out of it.

1

condition still open

In the first week

first action

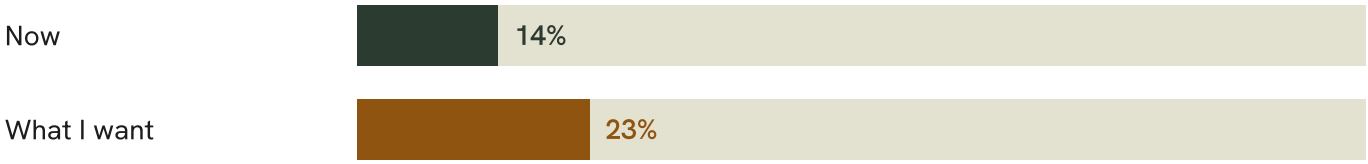
My own answers across the three steps of Phase 1, gathered on one document. It shows what I think today, with the open work visible. It is not advice, and it is not a recommendation to move.

WHAT I AM CHOOSING

Keep the life in the plan

Health, Freedom, Family, Nature, Simplicity. The change is only worth it if ordinary days make more room for these.

TIME I DECIDE FOR MYSELF



16 of my 112 waking hours a week are mine to choose today. The second figure is what I am aiming at.

WHAT I NEED / WHAT THE RESEARCH FOUND

Daylight after work, most days	Yes	Known
One whole day a week outdoors	Yes	Estimate
Rent I can pay without counting	Yes	Known
My sister within half an hour	Yes	Known
A patch of ground of my own	Partly	Estimate

WHAT I PROTECT / WHAT I ACCEPT

My job and the people in it. My flat and the rent I can afford. My sister ten minutes away. The Thursday market. Knowing the chemist by name.

Being the one who answers in the evening. The idea that the life I want is somewhere abroad. Two hours a day on screens that are not work.

I will know it worked if a normal Friday is spent outside and I have stopped reading about other people's countries.

03 / MONEY

What the numbers can carry

Monthly costs €2,210

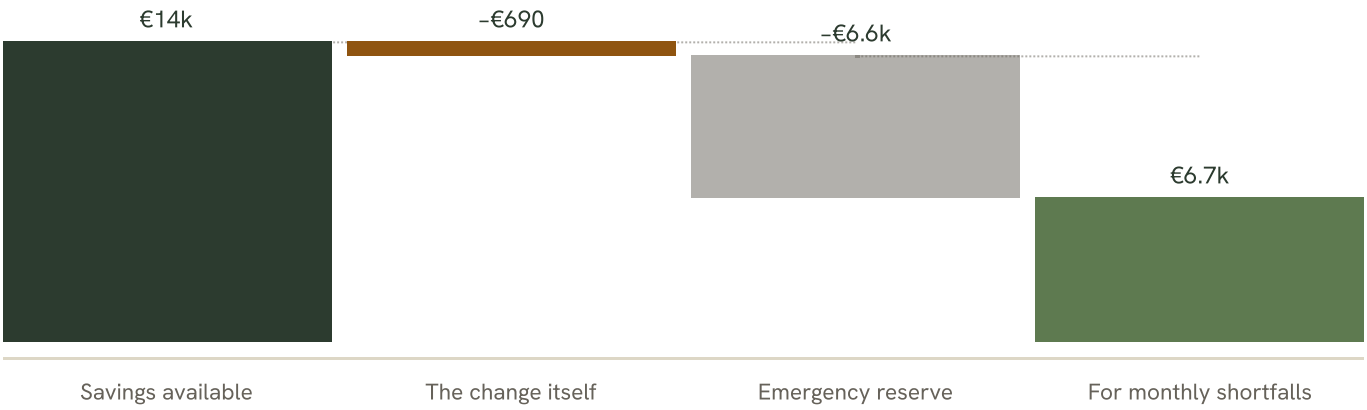
Income I can count on €2,360

€150

left over each month

On the income I can count on today.

HOW €14,000 BECOMES €6,710 TO LIVE ON



6

months I want

If everything costs 30% more: Costs €2,873 and I am €513 short each month. The reserve covers about 13 months. I would go back to five days for a season rather than spend it.

My runway divides the money left to live on (€6,710), not my savings: the reserve and the return fund are kept out of it on purpose. Nothing here is advice; these are my own figures.

MY NEXT CHAPTER

Prepare, check, then commit

Money	Papers	People	Place	Plan B
Amber	Green	Green	Green	Green
One full month lived on €2,360, with the rent and the bills paid out of it	Nothing to arrange. Same country, same contract, same address	My sister knows, and my manager has agreed to a meeting	I stay in the flat I know, at the rent I know	Four days is reversible, and the reserve is untouched

The colours are my own answers on the day. Nothing here says that anything is ready.

OPEN CONDITIONS

- **Money** — After the first month
  One full month lived on €2,360, with the rent and the bills paid out of it

MY FIRST ACTION

Ask my manager for a meeting about a four-day week., before In the first week.

A flat no from work with no room in it, or a month on the lower pay that does not add up.

MY WAY BACK

Not needed. The equivalent is the reserve, and the fact that four days is reversible.

I look at this decision again on In 8 weeks. Dealbreakers I carry forward: A week with no daylight in it. Moving away from my sister. Rent I have to think about on the first of the month.

IF I AM STAYING

My change plan

Four days a week in the same job, with Friday outdoors, and two evenings a week that end at six.

In place by the fourth month.

WHAT I KEEP

My job and the people in it, the flat, my sister ten minutes away, and the Thursday market.

THE SMALL TEST I RUN FIRST

Four weeks of evenings that end at six, and one unpaid Friday, before I ask for anything.

1

FIRST WEEK

Ask my manager for a meeting

What must be true first: A month of figures I believe

2

FIRST MONTH

Live on four-fifths pay on paper

What must be true first: Last three months of spending in front of me

3

SECOND MONTH

Put the request in writing

What must be true first: A yes in principle

4

THIRD MONTH

Take a corner of a neighbour's allotment

What must be true first: Tools and boots

5

FOURTH MONTH

First Friday outdoors

What must be true first: The change in place

IF I AM STAYING

What it rests on, and the way back

MONEY AND BUFFER

€2,360 a month from the fourth month, confirmed, against €2,210 of costs. The buffer stays at €6,600, three months of everything, untouched.

HOURS I DECIDE, BEFORE AND AFTER

About 16 hours a week now. About 26 after the change.

WHO I TELL

My sister first, then my manager, then the team. From my sister I need a standing Friday, so somebody is expecting me.

MY FIRST 90 DAYS

Week one, the meeting. After 30 days, two evenings a week that really end at six. After 90 days, the request agreed and in writing.

WHAT IS STILL UNCERTAIN

What the lower pay does to my pension over ten years. Whether I keep the Friday in January, when it is dark and wet.

MY PLAN B

If four days is refused, I keep the two evenings and ask again after six months, with one unpaid day a month meanwhile. If the lower pay does not add up, I go back to five days for a season rather than spend the reserve.

I look at this again: the third month after the change, and again after a year. Staying is a decision like any other, and this is the plan that goes with it.